

RESPONSIBLE COMPUTING: BRINGING TOGETHER LEGAL AND TECHNICAL PERSPECTIVES

February 4th, 2026

Columbia University, Northwest Corner Building: 550 W 120th St, 14th floor, Data Science Institute (DSI).

12:30-13:30 – Lunch and introductions

13:30 - 14:00 - lightning talks

14:00-15:00 – Keynote 1: **Data Sharing and Differential Privacy, Sergei Vassilvitskii**

Abstract: Differential privacy is the gold standard for statistical data release. Used by governments, companies, and academics, its mathematically rigorous guarantees and worst-case assumptions on the strength and knowledge of attackers make it a robust and compelling framework for reasoning about privacy. However, even with landmark successes, differential privacy has not achieved widespread adoption in everyday data use and data protection. In this talk we examine some recent data sharing regulations and examine some of the practical obstacles that stand in the way.

Bio: Sergei Vassilvitskii is a Distinguished Scientist and Senior Research Director at Google New York. His interests span all aspects of data systems: from algorithms and paradigms for data processing, to user privacy and legal rubrics for data protection. His work has won several best paper awards and has been presented to international regulators and other government stakeholders.

15:00-15:30 – Break

15:30-16:30 – Keynote 2: **Rethinking Frameworks for Algorithmic Fair Lending, Talia Gillis**

Machine learning models are now routinely used in consumer finance, with important implications for credit access and inequality. This talk explores how legal frameworks designed for human decision-making struggle to address algorithmic discrimination, and proposes paths forward through greater doctrinal precision and broadening the legal lens through which algorithmic harms are evaluated.

Traditional fair lending law focuses heavily on what goes into algorithms by scrutinizing inputs rather than outcomes. But this input-centric approach misses a fundamental challenge: algorithmic systems force precision in legal standards that have long relied on vagueness. When pricing models have explicit objective functions, we can no longer avoid asking whether profit maximization through price discrimination constitutes a legitimate business justification. When model performance involves clear accuracy-fairness tradeoffs, binary legal frameworks that offer no proportionality mechanism can become undesirable. Algorithmic

transparency doesn't just expose technical choices but exposes decades of unresolved doctrinal ambiguity.

This talk argues that meeting this moment requires both sharper tools and wider perspectives. I'll discuss how technical methods can operationalize underutilized legal requirements and make them enforceable in practice. I'll also show why we need to look beyond traditional discrimination frameworks, primarily by exploring consumer protection law as a more flexible approach that can address emerging harms from AI systems, from biased advice to quality disparities. As algorithmic decision-making shapes critical decisions and political challenges threaten existing protections, the responsible computing community has a role to play in building regulatory frameworks that are both robust and adaptive.

Bio: Talia Gillis is the Daniel G. Ross Professor of Law at Columbia Law School and an affiliate of Columbia's Data Science Institute. Her research examines the law and economics of consumer markets, with particular attention to how emerging technologies shape consumer welfare and impact distributional disparities. A central focus of her research is the use of AI in consumer credit and its impact on fair lending practices and doctrine. She has served as Program Co-Chair for ACM FAccT 2025 and will serve as General Chair of the ACM Computer Science & Law Symposium in 2027. She holds a Ph.D. in Business Economics from Harvard University and an SJD from Harvard Law School. Prior to her doctoral studies, she earned a BCL from Oxford University and an LL.B. in Law and Economics from the Hebrew University.

16:30-17:00 – Break

17:00-17:30 – Lightning talks

18:15 dinner at Jin Ramen